

NOVATECH SYSTEMS INC. · INCIDENTAL RESPONSE & THREAT INTELLIGENCE

Document Reference: IR-2026-0812-CRIT
Classification: INTERNAL / RESTRICTED (CONFIDENTIAL)
Date: August 14, 2026
Lead Investigator: Dr. Sarah Lin (Incident Response Team)
Contact: incident-response@novatech-internal.net | Desk: +1-555-019-4821

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

On August 12, 2026 at 03:14 UTC, NovaTech Systems' Security Operations Center (SOC) detected unauthorized anomalous encryption activity originating from an internal server (IP: 198.51.100.42). The threat actors gained initial foothold via a zero-day vulnerability in an unpatched legacy VPN gateway (host: vpn-edge02.novatech-int.com). Immediate containment protocols isolated the affected subnet within 42 minutes of detection. Critical database vaults holding encrypted customer data were secured. Further investigation is ongoing.

2. TIMELINE OF EVENTS

- August 12, 2026 - 02:45 UTC: Initial ingress detected on perimeter gateway.
- August 12, 2026 - 03:14 UTC: Automated alerts trigger on mass file encryption in storage pool C.
- August 12, 2026 - 03:56 UTC: SOC declares Severity-1 Critical Incident; network isolation executed.
- August 13, 2026 - 08:30 UTC: Backup verification completed; clean air-gapped snapshots confirmed intact.
- August 14, 2026 - 12:00 UTC: Incident report finalized for Executive Board and Government Cyber Advisory review.

3. IMPACT ANALYSIS

- Systems Affected: 500 production servers and administrative workstations.
- Operational Downtime: Enterprise billing and internal customer support portals remained degraded for 18 hours.
- Data Exposure Assessment: No confirmed customer PII or financial vault exfiltration. 120GB of internal diagnostic telemetry was staged.
- Severity Level: CRITICAL (CVSS Severity Score 9.4).

4. INDICATORS OF COMPROMISE (IoCs)

- SHA-256 Hash: e3b0c44298fc1c149afb4c8996fb92427ae41e4649b934ca495991b7852b855
- C2 Server IP: 198.51.100.42 (Port 8443)
- Malicious Process: hydra_svc.exe
- Registry Key: HKLM\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run\DarkHydraPersistence

5. REMEDIATION & STRATEGIC RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Credential Reset: Enforce enterprise-wide mandatory credential reset across all Active Directory and Cloud IAM accounts.
2. Network Isolation & Segmentation: Permanently isolate legacy VPN appliances and migrate all perimeter access to zero-trust architecture.
3. Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA): Mandate FIDO2 hardware security keys for all administrative and privileged access.
4. Comprehensive Log Audit: Conduct a 90-day retroactive log audit across all perimeter routers and domain controllers.

5. Air-gapped Backup Restoration: Re-image compromised host machines from immutable clean snapshots before bringing systems back

Authorized for internal dissemination and sanitized transformation into Government Advisory, Executive Briefing, and Public Communication